準1級

第9回

英検準1級形式

リーディング練習

第9回　｜　部分演習（筆記全体の制限時間は流用しません）　｜　選択問題 31問

■ 出題構成・自己採点記録表

大問	問題番号	出題形式・内容	設問数	自己採点・点検
1	(1)〜(18)	短文の語句空所補充	18問	／18
2	(19)〜(24)	長文の語句空所補充	6問	／6
3	(25)〜(31)	長文の内容一致選択	7問	／7

■ 演習・印刷の手引き

1. 問題冊子には正答や解説を載せていません。解答用紙はA4横マークシート（1ページ）です。
2. 印刷時は「白黒・実際のサイズ（100%）」を選ぶと、マーク欄や英作文罫線が本番見本に近い実寸で出力されます。
3. 解き終わるまでは「解答・解説」を開かず、本番と同じ時間配分を意識して取り組んでください。
4. 同じ選択問題はアプリの「分野別練習」、英作文課題はアプリの「ライティング練習」でも学習・保存できます。

実施日：　　年　　月　　日　　開始〜終了：　　：　　〜　　：

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿　　選択問題 合計：　　／31 点

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1

次の(1)から(18)までの（ ）に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選び、その番号のマーク欄をぬりつぶしなさい。

(1) The archaeological dig had to halt after autumn rains turned the clay trench into an impassable ( ).

1 quagmire **2** quandary **3** quorum **4** quintessence

(2) Far from offering fresh analysis, the consultant's slideshow merely ( ) statistics already published in the city's annual report.

1 relegated **2** rejuvenated **3** regurgitated **4** repudiated

(3) To keep dominant landlords from neglecting repairs, the housing code empowers tenants to ( ) a portion of rent in a court-supervised escrow account.

1 squander **2** sequester **3** subvert **4** surmise

(4) The botanist's field drawings are prized for their ( ) detail, capturing tiny stem hairs invisible in hasty snapshots.

1 strident **2** specious **3** sporadic **4** scrupulous

(5) Although the CEO apologized for the data leak, her ( ) tone during questioning convinced lawmakers that little would change.

1 perfunctory **2** penitent **3** perspicacious **4** plaintive

(6) Cold ocean currents upwelling along the Peruvian coast infuse surface waters with nutrients that ( ) one of Earth's richest anchovy fisheries.

1 undercut **2** underpin **3** usurp **4** upbraid

1 短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(7) Because emergency room triage must happen within seconds, intake forms strip away ( ) questions until the patient is stable.

1 arduous **2** acute **3** ancillary **4** astute

(8) The island's feral goats proved remarkably ( ), thriving on thorny scrub that domestic sheep refused to touch.

1 halcyon **2** haughty **3** hapless **4** hardy

(9) To prevent conflicts of interest, peer reviewers must ( ) themselves whenever a submitted manuscript comes from a former lab partner.

1 refute **2** rebuke **3** recuse **4** rescind

(10) What made the mediator indispensable was her ( ) temperament; even shouted insults failed to ruffle her composure.

1 equable **2** erratic **3** ersatz **4** ephemeral

(11) Rather than clarify tariff schedules, the hastily amended trade bill introduced three ( ) clauses that baffled customs brokers.

1 opulent **2** opaque **3** obsequious **4** opportune

(12) Historians caution against treating surviving court diaries as representative, since literacy at the time was the ( ) preserve of aristocrats and monks.

1 exuberant **2** expansive **3** extraneous **4** exclusive

1 短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(13) Continuous vibration from heavy freight trains can gradually ( ) mortar joints in century-old brick viaducts.

1 pulverize **2** placate **3** postulate **4** preclude

(14) Despite fierce lobbying by soda makers, epidemiological evidence linking sugary drinks to tooth decay proved ( ).

1 incorrigible **2** inconsequential **3** incoherent **4** incontrovertible

(15) Because Alpine rescue helicopters burn fuel rapidly in thin mountain air, pilots strip every kilogram of ( ) gear from the cabin.

1 nondescript **2** nonchalant **3** nonessential **4** nonpartisan

(16) The orchestra's surplus from summer outdoor pops concerts helped ( ) losses on adventurous contemporary chamber music series.

1 outstrip **2** offset **3** ostracize **4** obviate

(17) After months of polite hints failed to curb hallway noise, the dormitory warden decided to ( ) strict quiet-hour fines.

1 clamp down with **2** brush up on **3** cave in to **4** gloss over

(18) Initial excitement over the geothermal well began to ( ) once drilling crews hit corrosive brine three kilometers underground.

1 pile up **2** pan out **3** peter out **4** patch up

2 A 次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(19)から(21)までの（ ）に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選び、その番号のマーク欄をぬりつぶしなさい。

Why Modern Cargo Ships Are Testing High-Tech Sails Again

For more than a century after coal and diesel engines conquered ocean trade, wind power at sea seemed consigned to yacht clubs and maritime museums. Marine diesels burn heavy fuel reliably through calm doldrums and headwinds alike, enabling container liners and bulk carriers to promise factory managers predictable arrival dates. Yet shipping accounts for roughly three percent of global greenhouse-gas emissions, and batteries heavy enough to propel a sixty-thousand-ton grain carrier across the Pacific do not exist.

Faced with tightening maritime carbon levies, naval architects have returned to an inexhaustible, zero-weight fuel waiting right above the deck: ocean wind. Today's wind-assisted vessels look nothing like nineteenth-century clippers manned by dozens of sailors climbing rope rigging. Some ships mount towering vertical cylinders called Flettner rotors that spin electrically to harness air-pressure differences, while others raise rigid fiberglass wingsails or automated parafoil kites steered by weather-routing algorithms. When favorable crosswinds blow, hydraulic sensors trim the sails automatically, allowing captains to throttle back main engines without losing schedule speed. (***19***), fuel savings of eight to twenty percent per voyage have already been verified on commercial routes.

Wind propulsion will not replace marine engines outright in the foreseeable future; calm days, harbor maneuvers, and narrow canals still demand dependable shaft power, ultimately supplied by cleaner fuels such as green methanol. (***20***), retrofitting collapsible sails that fold flat beneath port cranes lets existing bulk carriers cut fuel burn immediately rather than waiting twenty-five years for fleet turnover.

Blending centuries-old aerodynamics with automated controls shows that decarbonizing heavy transport often relies on (***21***).

(19) **1** On the contrary **2** In practice **3** Otherwise **4** Regrettably

(20) **1** Until then **2** Consequently **3** For example **4** Even so

(21)

1 reinventing proven physical principles with modern precision

2 replacing sixty-thousand-ton grain ships with wooden rowboats

3 waiting until lithium batteries weigh nothing at all

4 banning cargo ships from crossing the Pacific Ocean

2 B 次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(22)から(24)までの（ ）に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選び、その番号のマーク欄をぬりつぶしなさい。

Why Translating Idioms Tests Both AI and Human Judgment

Machine translation systems trained on billions of bilingual sentences now render technical manuals, weather bulletins, and hotel reservations with impressive fluency. Give an algorithm a parliamentary speech, a novel, or an informal workplace email, however, and figurative idioms still expose the subtle boundary between matching statistical patterns and grasping lived social context.

Consider what happens when a speaker says a delayed rail project has "kicked the can down the road" or describes a colleague in Japanese as having "wide shoulders" versus a "broad face" (meaning extensive social connections). Literal word-by-word rendering produces comical nonsense, of course. Modern neural translators usually recognize common idioms and substitute a dictionary equivalent in the target language. Yet equivalence is rarely one-to-one across cultures: a sporting metaphor that sounds brisk and neutral in American boardrooms—such as "throwing a curveball"—can puzzle British or German readers unfamiliar with baseball, or strike Japanese clients as overly casual in an apology letter. (***22***), choosing how to translate an idiom requires judging register, power relations, and what the audience actually needs to feel.

Professional literary and diplomatic translators sometimes replace a source metaphor with a fresh image rooted in the target culture; in other cases, when a leader's specific regional proverb carries political symbolism, they keep the original image and add a subtle contextual gloss. (***23***), over-smoothing every colorful foreign expression into bland domestic clichés erases the distinctive voice that readers came to experience.

Automated tools save translators immense routine labor, yet navigating metaphor reminds us that translation is ultimately (***24***).

(22) **1** On the contrary **2** Consequently **3** Otherwise **4** Despite this

(23) **1** Until then **2** Conversely **3** After all **4** By accident

(24)

1 restricted to hotel reservations and weather bulletins

2 impossible whenever a speaker uses sports vocabulary

3 best handled by translating every proverb word for word

4 an act of cultural negotiation rather than mere word substitution

3 A 次の英文の内容に関して、(25)から(27)までの質問に対する答えとして最も適切なもの、または文を完成させるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

Ghost Fishing Gear and Acoustic Recovery Tags

Public campaigns against ocean plastic understandably focus on single-use shopping bags, beverage bottles, and food wrappers washing off city streets. Survey the heaviest plastic debris tangled on offshore reefs and continental shelves, however, and marine biologists consistently find something built specifically to catch sea life: lost, abandoned, or storm-severed commercial fishing gear. Synthetic nylon gillnets, trawls, and crab pots engineered to resist saltwater rot for decades continue trapping cod, sea turtles, and diving seabirds long after their owners lose track of them—a cycle known as "ghost fishing."

Fishers rarely abandon expensive gear on purpose. Winter gales snap surface marker buoys, passing cargo vessels slice tether lines at night, or currents drag crab traps onto rocky ledges where grappling hooks cannot find them. Historically, once a surface buoy vanished in deep, murky water, locating a sunken trap line on the seabed was nearly hopeless, leaving both the fisher out thousands of dollars and the marine habitat saddled with a perpetual snare.

A combination of acoustic transponders and cooperative harbor rules is beginning to break this stalemate. Compact battery-powered "pingers" clipped to underwater trap frames remain silent until interrogated by a search vessel's hull hydrophone, then reply with a coded ultrasonic pulse pinpointing the gear's coordinates within meters. Equally crucial has been reforming legal incentives: ports that previously fined captains who brought up unmarked tangled nets saw crews dump recovered debris back overboard; replacing penalties with free dockside recycling bins and modest retrieval bounties has turned working trawlers into effective seabed cleanup partners.

3A Ghost Fishing Gear and Acoustic Recovery Tags　設問 (25)〜(27)

(25) Why is lost synthetic fishing gear especially destructive compared with ordinary household plastic waste?

1 It dissolves into toxic dye within forty-eight hours.

2 It floats exclusively on sandy tourist beaches.

3 Engineered not to rot in seawater, it is specifically designed to trap marine animals and continues doing so unattended.

4 Fishers deliberately sink old nets every week to build artificial reefs.

(26) How do compact underwater acoustic "pingers" help crews recover lost crab traps?

1 They respond to a search boat's hydrophone signal with a coded ultrasonic pulse that locates the gear within meters.

2 They inflate giant orange balloons automatically every Tuesday.

3 They cut nylon ropes so traps float into harbor entrances.

4 They broadcast continuous music loud enough to hear from shore.

(27) Why had strict port fines for landing unmarked nets previously backfired?

1 Captains stopped using surface marker buoys on sunny days.

2 Fines encouraged crews to drop accidentally snagged ghost nets back into the sea rather than bring them ashore.

3 Recycling companies charged ports millions of dollars per net.

4 Hydrophones could not operate near harbors with fines.

3 B

次の英文の内容に関して、(28)から(31)までの質問に対する答えとして最も適切なもの、または文を完成させるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

Acoustic Archaeology at Prehistoric Monuments

Generations of archaeologists studying Neolithic stone circles, chambered cairns, and painted caves approached their sites almost exclusively through visual eyes: mapping alignments with solstice sunrises, cataloging carved spirals, and analyzing stone quarries. Only in recent decades have researchers begun systematically asking a question that prehistoric builders could hardly have ignored—what did these spaces sound like during ceremonies?

Armed with omnidirectional speakers and precision microphone arrays borrowed from concert-hall engineering, "archaeoacousticians" have measured impulse responses inside surviving megalithic tombs across Britain, Ireland, and Malta, as well as full-scale reconstructions of Stonehenge's original sarsen ring. Their measurements reveal striking acoustic signatures. Close-set upright monoliths reflect human voices and frame-drum beats inward, boosting volume inside the circle by several decibels while muffling sound just paces outside the stone perimeter. Inside narrow passage graves, rhythmic drumming near two hertz—matching a resting heartbeat—excites standing bass waves that listeners feel physically in their chests, creating an eerie illusion that sound emanates from the rock walls themselves.

Proving intentional acoustic design in preliterate societies requires disciplined skepticism, however. Any enclosed stone chamber or ring of pillars will produce echoes simply as an accidental byproduct of geometry; showing that Neolithic builders deliberately tuned walls for resonance demands more than admiring an impressive reverberation today. Moreover, millennia of collapsed roofs, turf restoration, and modern concrete stabilization can alter a monument's original soundscape substantially.

Even with those caveats, acoustic archaeology has enriched prehistory where independent clues converge—such as French Paleolithic caves where red ochre paintings cluster disproportionately in the exact niches with the strongest vocal resonance, while acoustically dead alcoves nearby sit bare. Prehistoric monuments were evidently experienced not as silent postcards, but as multisensory theaters.

3B Acoustic Archaeology at Prehistoric Monuments 設問 (28)〜(31)

(28) What acoustic effect did measurements reveal about upright stones arranged in a ring like Stonehenge?

1 They project whispers five kilometers across open plains.

2 They echo only on the morning of the summer solstice.

3 They absorb all bass frequencies so drums sound completely silent inside.

4 They reflect voices and drumbeats inward while sharply reducing sound audible outside the circle.

(29) Why do scholars urge caution before claiming that Neolithic builders intentionally engineered every echo found today?

1 Echoes can arise as incidental byproducts of stone geometry, and later decay or repairs may have altered original acoustics.

2 Prehistoric people lacked the vocal cords needed to sing or chant.

3 Concert-hall microphones cannot measure frequencies below ten thousand hertz.

4 Written construction manuals from Neolithic Britain explicitly deny any interest in sound.

(30) What evidence in certain French Paleolithic caves strengthens the case that prehistoric people noticed and valued acoustics?

1 Musical scores were carved beside cave entrances.

2 Modern concrete walls inside the caves amplify tourists' footsteps.

3 Stalagmites were sawed into equal organ pipes and carried outside.

4 Ochre paintings are concentrated specifically in niches with strong vocal resonance while nearby dead spots lack art.

(31) What broader shift in understanding prehistoric monuments does the passage describe?

1 Abandoning astronomical alignment studies as completely false.

2 Proving that chambered cairns served solely as grain warehouses.

3 Viewing monuments as multisensory spaces rather than purely visual objects.

4 Replacing archaeological excavation with computer-generated music.